

NUCLEAR SEQUENCING ONE-PAGER

Resolving the Central Obstacle: Iran's Deferred Nuclear Window vs. US Immediate HEU Verification

Document Source: The Final Steps Accord v3.3 | Purpose: To show both sides how the Accord solves their core demand simultaneously

THE PROBLEM

Iran's Position	US Position
"Nuclear details must be deferred to a later phase. We will not discuss final HEU disposition now."	"We need concrete commitments on the HEU stockpile before signing any deal. Iran must physically surrender its weapons-grade uranium up front."
Both positions are in the text. Neither side has to concede its public narrative.	

THE SOLUTION: PHASE 1 / PHASE 2 DECOUPLING

Source: The Final Steps Accord v3.3, Article 1.2 (Page 7)

Phase	Timeline	Iranian Commitment	US Reciprocal	Final Disposition
Phase 1: Baseline Verification	Days 1–30	Physical consolidation, inventory, and IAEA custody activation (Pathway A or B). Mass spectrometry confirms isotopic composition. Dual-lock seals applied.	\$250M tranche; OFAC license; 5th Fleet stand-off posture; sanctions designation freeze	Deferred. No final disposition required. Baseline verification satisfies Phase 1 trigger.
Phase 2: Nuclear Negotiating Window	Days 30–60	Participation in dedicated nuclear negotiating track to determine final HEU disposition from the six-pathway menu.	Tranche 2 release (25% of remaining frozen assets); petrochemical licenses	Negotiated. Iran selects disposition pathway. US verifies execution. No US veto over pathway selected.

WHAT IRAN GETS

"No final disposition required in Phase 1. Nuclear details deferred to Phase 2 (Days 30-60). Iran selects the final disposition pathway from a six-option menu. The United States has no veto over the pathway selected."

Source: Article 1.2, Page 7

WHAT THE US GETS

"The entire stockpile of uranium enriched to 60% is consolidated, inventoried, and placed under IAEA custody within the first 72 hours. Physical custody transfer is verified by mass spectrometry. Breakout time extended from weeks to over a year."

Source: Article 1.1, Page 6

LEGAL TITLE REASSURANCE (FOR IRAN)

"The Central Bank of Iran retains full sovereign legal title to the HEU throughout the custody period. The IAEA holds physical custody only."

Source: Article 1.1, Page 6

NO HIDDEN US CUSTODY CLAUSE (FOR IRAN)

"At no stage may the United States receive, store, transport, or exercise operational control over the Iranian enriched-uranium stockpile. All custody remains with the IAEA. US personnel shall not be present at any consolidation, packaging, transit, or receipt operation. This clause is self-executing and non-waivable."

Source: Article 1.3, Page 8

THE DEADLOCK BREAKER (If Phase 2 Negotiations Stall)

Source: The Final Steps Accord v3.3, Addendum A-3, Article 2.4.3 (Page 44)

"If the JCC certifies deadlock on Day 45, Pathway A (in-country downblending to 19.75%) shall be deemed the default disposition and shall commence within 7 days."

Iran's Minimum	US Minimum
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HEU material remains in-country at Esfahan	Downblending to medical-grade LEU verified by IAEA within 7 days
<i>Neither Party's failure to agree on an alternative pathway is construed as material breach.</i>	

THE SIX PATHWAYS FOR FINAL DISPOSITION (Phase 2, Days 30–60)

Source: The Final Steps Accord v3.3, Article 1.5 (Page 9)

Path	Description	Destination	Timeline
A	In-place downblending to medical-grade LEU at Esfahan	Medical isotope production in Iran	142 days
B	HEU export to IAEA custody in Oman	IAEA facility, Oman (NOT US)	14 days
C	Downblended in Iran, transferred to IAEA LEU Bank	Oskemen, Kazakhstan	75 days
D	Transfer to Rosatom under IAEA safeguards	Russian Federation	60–90 days
E	Conversion to reactor-grade LEU fuel assemblies	Bushehr reactor supply	180 days
F	Hybrid: stockpile divided into batches through different pathways	Multiple destinations	Concurrent

Iran selects the pathway. The United States has no veto — only the right to verify execution.

THE NARRATIVES (What Each Side Can Say)

FOR THE UNITED STATES	FOR THE ISLAMIC REPUBLIC OF IRAN
<i>"Weapons-grade uranium secured — the entire Iranian stockpile of near-weapons-grade material has been placed under IAEA custody with US monitoring access. Breakout time extended from weeks to over a year. Physical verification is immediate."</i>	<i>"Iran's enriched uranium remains Iranian property. The Central Bank of Iran retains sovereign title. Physical custody to IAEA is a verification step in a broader negotiation — not surrender. Final disposition will be decided in the nuclear negotiating window on terms that respect our NPT rights."</i>

ONE PAGE SUMMARY

Iran's Demand	US Demand	How the Accord Resolves It
Nuclear details deferred to later phase	HEU secured before signing	Phase 1 (Days 1-30): Physical custody to IAEA. No final disposition required. Phase 2 (Days 30-60): Nuclear negotiations on final disposition.
Iran retains legal title	US has monitoring access	Article 1.1: CBI retains full sovereign legal title. IAEA holds physical custody only. US has real-time monitoring access.
No US veto over disposition	US can verify compliance	Article 1.5: Iran selects pathway. US has no veto — only right to verify execution.
Deadlock protection	Deadlock protection	Addendum A-3: Day 45 automatic default — Pathway A (in-country downblending to 19.75%) within 7 days. Neither side's failure to agree is a breach.